

**Some states have passed laws that offer new parents paid maternity leave and, in many cases, paternity leave.** California was the first state to pass such legislation. Through its Paid Family Leave Program, employees who participate in the State Disability Insurance Program can receive up to six weeks of partial pay for time off within the first year of their baby's birth. Two other states, Washington and New Jersey, have passed similar legislation, and other states may follow suit. Find out about the laws in your state.

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## **BETTER BREAKS FOR PARENTS ABROAD**

**A recent report from researchers at Harvard University and McGill University** found the US lags behind most other countries when it comes to paid maternity and paternity leave. Out of 173 countries studied, 168 offered working women guaranteed paid maternity leave. The US was one of only five countries that did not, along with Lesotho, Liberia, Papua New Guinea, and Swaziland. Sixty-six countries offered men paid paternity leave; the US did not.

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## **QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS**

**If I have to take a pregnancy-related absence, will my employer hold my job for me or will I be left without my job when I'm ready to return to work?**

According to the Pregnancy Discrimination Act, employers must hold open a job for a pregnancy-related absence for the same length of time that jobs are held open for employees on sick leave or on disability leave.

**What happens to my eligibility for a bonus if I go on FMLA leave?**

You'll still be eligible. The Family and Medical Leave Act requires an employee to be given her same, or an equivalent, position, and that would include eligibility for bonuses, including perfect attendance bonuses. If you don't miss days before or after your FMLA leave, you will still be eligible for that bonus.

**I've just been offered my dream job, but I'm eight weeks' pregnant. Should I keep mum or should I say something to my new employer?**

The Pregnancy Discrimination Act states that employers cannot refuse to hire a woman because of her pregnancy or a because of a pregnancy-related condition.

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## **BABY AND CHILD BENEFITS**

**Your baby will need health insurance coverage just like you do.** When your baby is born, you'll need to add them to your health insurance plan so they can get the coverage they will need. Most health insurance companies make the process easy. Typically you'll just need to call your health plan and tell them your baby's name and the date of your baby's birth, and your baby will automatically be added to your plan. For most insurance plans, you will have 30 days to give notice of the birth. From then, your baby will be covered for doctor appointments in the same way that you are.